

DIGITAL LITERACY

BLOCK 1: The internet around us: devices, apps and digital footprints

Who this is for	Grades 7-9 works in mixed-ability classrooms
Total time each month	4 hours per month per subject
Best pairing in our timetable	Pairs well with Financial Literacy because scam safety, fraud prevention, and practical decision-making overlap.
Core materials	board, slips, printed fake messages/screenshots, scenario cards

By the end of the month, students should be able to:

- understand basic digital footprint, privacy, password, and OTP safety
- spot common online risks such as fake links, scam messages, impersonation, and blackmail
- respond better to cyberbullying, unwanted contact, and harmful content
- check information before believing or forwarding it
- know the basic reporting path for cyber harm and online fraud

Block flow

Time	Step	What we will do
0-8 min	Hook	Ask students where they meet the internet in real life, even if the

Time	Step	What we will do
		device is not theirs.
8-18 min	Teach	Explain digital footprint using local examples: profile photo, forwards, comments, saved images, screenshots.
18-30 min	Demonstration	Run the Footprint String Game.
30-42 min	Discussion	Ask what should never be posted or forwarded without thinking.
42-55 min	Group task	Groups create two lists: 'safe to share' and 'not safe to share'.
55-60 min	Close	Each group gives one digital rule they want to remember.

What is “Digital”

Make sure that they understand that ‘digital use’ includes a extremely large variety of activities like using a mobile phone or searching up anything on google. To simply opening up any app.

Points to convey:

- Ensure that they understand what is counted as 'digital use'
- Make sure that they understand the risks and benefits associated with 'digital use'
- This includes that they should not share sensitive information like their respective address or phone numbers or OTP's online. (Segue to OTP's)
- Ensure that they understand what a OTP is and where it is likely to be used and how to handle one properly.

Main activity: for both topics

Digital Footprint String Game: One volunteer starts with a paper 'message'. It is passed to 8-10 people, then we ask: can we control where it went? This leads into the idea of screenshots, forwards, and digital traces.

Digital Footprint:

Simple Definition

A digital footprint is the trail of information you leave behind when you use the internet.

Points to convey not just definitions:

- Make sure they understand that whatever they do online doesn't just disappear but can be traced back to them
- understand that online activity can have real-life consequences
- use the internet thoughtfully and not do online activity that can result in reputational damage or worse

Main activity: (same one as before)

Digital Footprint String Game: One volunteer starts with a paper 'message'. It is passed to 8-10 people, then we ask: can we control where it went? This leads into the idea of screenshots, forwards, and digital traces.

Key message:

Using the internet always leaves a footprint so think before taking any online action.

BLOCK 2: Passwords, OTPs, Scams and Fraud prevention

Block flow

Time	Step	What we will do
0-10 min	Warm-up	Quick ask: who has heard 'never share OTP'? Why?
10-20 min	Teach	Explain password basics, OTPs, fake links, fake reward messages, and impersonation.
20-38 min	Scam detective	Groups analyse message cards and mark red flags.
38-48 min	Demonstration	Facilitator performs a fake scam call. Students interrupt and identify warning signs.
48-56 min	Protection rules	Build a class list: pause, verify, ask, do not click, do not pay, do

Time	Step	What we will do
		not share.
56-60 min	Close	Students repeat the line: 'No OTP, PIN, or password sharing. Ever.'

PASSWORD: A password is a secret word or set of letters, numbers, and symbols used to protect your account or device.

Points to convey:

- Never reuse the same password.
- Do not share your password with anyone
- A strong password contains letters, numbers and symbols (teaching objective)

OTP (One-Time Password): An OTP is a special code that can be used only once to verify your identity. It is usually sent to your phone or email to help keep your account secure.

Points to convey:

- Never share a OTP with anyone
- Always opt to login with a method that requires a OTP as it is more secure.

SCAMS: A scam is a dishonest trick used to fool people into giving away their money, personal information, or passwords. Scammers often pretend to be trusted people or companies to deceive others.

Points to convey:

- How to identify a scam? A scam often has the scammer sharing a link or claiming to be a trusted person or company and includes them asking for sensitive data or money. Scams often use urgency or fear to trigger a response.
- Never click on unknown links or messages from strangers
- Always verify any messages or claims by anyone online before taking any action
- Never share your personal information such as bank details or addresses online with anyone

FRAUD PREVENTION:

Points to convey:

- Never share sensitive data with anyone online (sensitive data contains things like passwords and OTPs)
- Always think twice before clicking on any unknown links or taking any action that might compromise your personal data

MAIN ACTIVITY (COMMON FOR ALL):

Scam Detective: We show groups 6-8 fake messages/call scripts. Each group marks what makes it suspicious: urgency, spelling, money promise, OTP request, unknown link, fake number, or fear tactic.

Key message:

Never share sensitive data online with anyone, always double-check any links or threats that may have been sent to you

BLOCK 3: cyberbullying, Consent, Online behaviour and Misinformation

Block flow

Time	Step	What we will do
0-10 min	Starter	Ask: 'Is forwarding something the same as creating it?' Use answers to open discussion.
10-22 min	Teach	Explain cyberbullying, consent, and misinformation in plain language.
22-38 min	Sorting activity	Run Forward or Stop? with group discussion.
38-48 min	Mini debate	Is 'just joking' okay if someone is humiliated? Discuss.
48-55 min	Class code	Create a 5-line Saath Digital Code for respectful online behaviour.
55-60 min	Close	Students sign or repeat the digital code.

CYBERBULLYING: Cyberbullying is the use of the internet, social media, or digital devices to hurt, threaten, or embarrass someone. It can include sending mean messages, spreading rumors, or sharing harmful content online.

Points to convey:

- Cyberbullying is as simple as making a joke or comment on someone that may have made them feel embarrassed or sad
- How to deal with cyberbullying? Always start by collecting evidence and then blocking the person that is contacting you and then tell a trusted adult such as your parents or teachers and take appropriate further action as per the trusted adult
- Never partake in any method of cyberbullying and always report such cases online to the [National cyber crime helpline at 1930](#)

CONSENT: Consent means asking for and receiving permission before sharing someone else's photo, video, chat, or personal information online.

Points to convey:

- Always ask permission before posting or sharing someone else's photo, video, or messages.
- Never share someone's phone number or personal information without their permission.
- If someone says "no", respect their decision.
- Sharing private information without permission can hurt someone and damage trust.

ONLINE BEHAVIOUR (Digital Citizenship): Online behaviour means the way we act and communicate with others on the internet.

Points to convey:

- Treat people online with the same respect you would show them in person.
- Think before you post, comment, or send a message.
- Avoid using rude, hateful, or hurtful language.
- Remember that your online behaviour becomes part of your digital footprint.

MISINFORMATION: Misinformation is false or incorrect information that is shared, even if the person sharing it does not know it is untrue.

Points to convey:

- Do not believe everything you see online.
- Check who shared the information and whether it comes from a trusted source.
- If something sounds shocking or unbelievable, verify it before forwarding.
- Forwarding false information can create panic and spread confusion.

MAIN ACTIVITY (COMMON FOR ALL):

Forward or Stop?

Groups receive different examples such as:

- A school notice
- A scary rumour
- A morphed image
- A funny screenshot
- A fake health message

Each group decides whether they should:

- **Forward**
- **Check First**
- **Stop Completely**

Students explain the reason behind every choice. Leading to a interactive session that engages all the students.

Key message:

Be kind, ask permission, and always verify information before sharing it online

BLOCK 4: What to do when something goes wrong online?

Block flow

Time	Step	What we will do
0-10 min	Teach	Explain response formula: stop - save proof - block/report - tell a trusted adult - use official help if needed.
10-35 min	Station drill	Groups complete response sheets at four stations.
35-45 min	Review	Correct the order of steps together.
45-53 min	Reporting map	Write the cyber help path on the board: teacher/parent - cyber helpline - reporting portal - police if needed.
53-58 min	Confidence round	Students practise saying: 'I have proof. I need help. This happened online.'
58-60 min	Close	Quick oral quiz on safe response.

RESPONDING TO ONLINE PROBLEMS: If something unsafe happens online, staying calm and taking the right steps can help protect you and others.

Points to convey:

- Stop replying to the person immediately if they are threatening, bullying, or asking for personal information.
- Save screenshots, messages, usernames, or any evidence before deleting or blocking someone.
- Block and report suspicious accounts, fake profiles, or harmful messages.
- Tell a trusted adult such as a parent, guardian, or teacher as soon as possible.
- Never feel embarrassed about asking for help. Online problems can happen to anyone.

REPORTING CYBER CRIME: Serious online fraud, scams, bullying, or fake accounts can be reported to the National Cyber Crime Helpline (1930) or through the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal.

Points to convey:

- Report scams or fraud as quickly as possible.
- Do not delete important evidence until it has been saved.
- Trusted adults can help make reports if needed.
- Reporting helps prevent the same scam from affecting other people.

MAIN ACTIVITY (COMMON FOR ALL):

Response Drill Stations:

Groups rotate through four situations:

- You receive a fake prize message.
- Someone is bullying a student in the class WhatsApp group.
- An unknown person asks for your photos.
- Someone asks you to pay money through an unknown link.

For each situation, groups write the correct response steps in order:

1. Stop replying.
2. Save evidence.
3. Block the account.
4. Report it.
5. Tell a trusted adult.

Key message:

Stay calm, save proof, block, report, and tell a trusted adult. Never deal with online problems alone.

SAATH Digital Literacy – Teaching Material

Common teaching materials:

- Chart paper or old newspaper sheets
- Sketch pens/chalk/board markers
- A4 worksheets if printing is possible
- Masking tape
- One whistle or clap signal if school allows
- A notebook for attendance, observations and follow up points

Block 1 – The Internet Around Us:

- What is digital? Using phones, apps, websites, games, school computers and shared devices.
- Digital Footprint: A digital footprint is the trail of information you leave behind when you use the internet.
- Key teaching points: think before posting; screenshots last; private chats can become public; don't share personal information.
- Activity: Digital Footprint String Game.
- Discussion questions: What is safe to share? What should never be shared?

Block 2 – Passwords, OTPs, Scams & Fraud Prevention:

- Password: A secret word or combination of letters, numbers and symbols that protects an account.
- OTP: A one-time code used to verify your identity. Never share it.
- Scam: A dishonest trick to steal money or personal information.
- Fraud prevention: Pause, verify, ask before clicking.
- Red flags: urgency, prizes, unknown links, requests for OTPs or money.
- Activity: Scam Detective using fake messages.

Block 3 – Cyberbullying, Consent, Online Behaviour & Misinformation:

- Cyberbullying: Using digital platforms to hurt, threaten or embarrass someone.
- Consent: Always ask before sharing someone else's photo, video or personal information.
- Online behaviour: Be respectful online just as you are offline.
- Misinformation: False information shared without checking.
- Activity: 'Forward or Stop?' sorting exercise.
- Key message: Be kind, ask permission and verify before forwarding.

Block 4 – What To Do When Something Goes Wrong Online:

- Response steps: Stop replying – Save evidence – Block – Report – Tell a trusted adult.
- Evidence includes screenshots, usernames, links and chat history.

- National Cyber Crime Helpline: 1930.
- Activity: Response Drill Stations with realistic scenarios.
- Key message: Stay calm, save proof and ask for help.

Quick Definitions:

- Password: Protects your account or device.
- OTP: A code used once to verify your identity.
- Scam: A trick to steal money or information.
- Cyberbullying: Hurting or embarrassing someone using digital technology.
- Digital Footprint: The trail you leave behind online.
- Consent: Permission before sharing someone else's information or content.

Tips:

- Keep language simple and interactive.
- Use real-life examples.
- Avoid asking students to share personal experiences of abuse or scams.
- Encourage questions and group discussions.
- End each session with one key takeaway students can remember.

Everyday examples for teaching:

BLOCK 1 – The Internet Around Us: Devices, Apps and Digital Footprints

Examples of Digital Use

- Watching videos on YouTube.
- Sending messages on WhatsApp.
- Playing online games.
- Posting a photo on Instagram.
- Commenting on a friend's post.
- Joining an online class.
- Downloading an app.
- Watching reels or short videos.

Safe to Share online:

- Favourite hobby
- Favourite sport
- School achievements

Not Safe to Share online:

- Home address
- Phone number

- Password
- OTP
- Bank details
- Live location
- Personal documents

Example of a Digital Footprint: Someone posts a funny picture of his friend in the class group. Even after deleting it, three classmates have already taken screenshots and forwarded it.

Teaching Point: Once something is online, you may lose control over who sees it. Ties in well with the activity for this block

Discussion Questions for open-ended answers:

- Can deleted messages always disappear?
- Why do people take screenshots?
- What happens if someone shares your photo without asking?

BLOCK 2 – Passwords, OTPs, Scams and Fraud Prevention

Teaching Point:

A strong password should contain:

- Uppercase letters
- Lowercase letters
- Numbers
- Symbols

OTP Example:

You are logging into any website

The website sends:

OTP: **428913**

Only you should enter this code.

If someone asks for it, never share it.

Common Red Flags to identify scams:

- Competitions you never entered
- Urgency
- Unknown link
- Time pressure
- Unknown website
- Fear or intimidation

BLOCK 3 – Cyberbullying, Consent, Online Behavior and Misinformation

Cyberbullying Examples:

- Making fun of someone's photo.
- Sending insulting messages.
- Spreading rumours online.
- Posting embarrassing videos without permission.

Good Online Behavior:

- Think before posting.
- Be respectful.
- Help others.
- Report bullying.
- Use kind language.

Poor Online Behavior:

- Name-calling
- Threats
- Spreading rumours
- Sharing private chats
- Posting without permission

BLOCK 4 – What To Do When Something Goes Wrong Online

Mini Quiz Questions:

1. Should you ever share your OTP?
2. Name two signs of a scam.
3. What is cyberbullying?

4. What should you do before forwarding a message?
5. What is a digital footprint?
6. What should you do if someone asks for your password?
7. Give one example of consent online.
8. Name one trusted adult you could tell if something goes wrong online.
9. What should you do if someone creates a fake account using your photo?
10. Why is it important to think before posting online?